

Twelve strategic hypotheses: results, alternatives and falsifiers

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H-01 / Customer cash constraints may matter more than national category size for a particular pack or route.

Designed field test. Test: Compare matched cash tickets/cost per use and net paid contribution by cohort. Competing explanation: Income/product mix or distributor liquidity rather than pack cash constraint. Result: No observed result; cash-ticket arithmetic only. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: No effect after controlling usable cost, income, credit and availability.

H-02 / A reliably delivered staple may outperform a heavily advertised but intermittently available alternative.

Designed field test. Test: Randomize reliable availability/service versus advertising, cap verified deliveries. Competing explanation: Seasonality or stock loading. Result: Chosen capacity counterexample supports possibility; no empirical superiority. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Reliable service fails incremental paid contribution versus controls.

H-03 / Technical service that improves customer output economics may create durable commercial value beyond awareness.

Designed field test. Test: Baker/feed usable-output trial and paid repeat after service ends. Competing explanation: Selection of skilled customers, formulation or price. Result: Teaching yield economics only. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Measured output advantage disappears or service consumes contribution.

H-04 / Working-capital improvement may change the expansion ranking more than revenue growth.

Executed template sensitivity. Test: Same-input DSO/DIO sensitivity versus order-factor changes. Competing explanation: Cost/price variation or capex. Result: Cash inclusion changes normalized value; actual expansion ranking untested. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Actual cash improvements are immaterial or unachievable.

H-05 / Local processing can hedge some policy or freight exposure while creating new raw-input, financing, or water exposure.

Scenario/design. Test: Matched processing/trade cases with raw-input, rights, water and funding gates. Competing explanation: A tariff spread mistaken for durable hedge. Result: All fixed modes fail some worlds; actual hedge effect untested. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Local processing has higher joint exposure or negative funded spread.

H-06 / A small, transferable pilot may change many later allocation decisions more than a large market launch.

Executed learning example. Test: Bayesian EVSI with imperfect symmetric test, plus transfer protocol. Competing explanation: Test too inaccurate or learning not transferable. Result: Net EVSI 0.7 USDm at chosen $p=.5, q=.8$; negative below $q \approx .7222$. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Quoted cost/delay exceeds decision improvement or no transferable update.

H-07 / A sourcing portfolio diversified by country may still be concentrated by climate regime or shipping corridor.

Executed chosen dependence stress. Test: Compare same marginal shocks independent versus common factor. Competing explanation: Higher marginal volatility rather than dependence. Result: Generator comparison published; no fitted country covariance. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Actual origins/ports/basins independent or measured tail gain absent.

H-08 / Health-related product opportunities may require price and distribution innovation more than premium positioning.

Designed field test. Test: Affordable-use formulation/pack $\times$ distribution trial. Competing explanation: Premium signaling or temporary subsidy. Result: No observed health-product willingness to pay. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: No paid repeat/contribution without subsidy.

H-09 / Trade disruption may create temporary spreads that do not justify permanent assets.

Scenario/design. Test: Temporary trade reset versus permanent capex DCF. Competing explanation: Persistent structural barrier rather than short-lived spread. Result: No observed duration; stage reversible lot instead of plant. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Bankable durable

volume/spread makes full financed asset positive.

H-10 / A low-NPV project in isolation may be useful as backup network capacity, but only if the avoided-loss mechanism is measurable and consolidated.

Executed network teaching model. Test: Avoided-loss constrained flow, no duplicate baseline synergy. Competing explanation: Unfunded idle capacity or overstated disruption loss. Result: LP proves feasible allocation mechanism only; actual backup NPV untested. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Measured avoided losses below cost/cash opportunity cost.

H-11 / Better information can be valuable while a resulting decision is to stop spending.

Executed information example. Test: Study update may optimally choose wait after negative signal. Competing explanation: Uninformative study or decision already fixed. Result: Chosen posterior negative signal selects wait; study can have value. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: No decision switching or net EVSI $\leq$ 0.

H-12 / A 25-year strategy may be most effective when it defines adaptive rules rather than a fixed country entry timetable.

Adaptive design. Test: Trigger rules with rolling evidence and same-world counterfactual. Competing explanation: Fixed policy simpler and cheaper. Result: Chosen minimax/learning examples change choice; no Olam policy superiority. Uncertainty: Chosen example or unexecuted internal field test; no calibrated Olam causal or 25-year outcome. Falsifier: Empirical benchmarks achieve equal outcomes at less complexity.